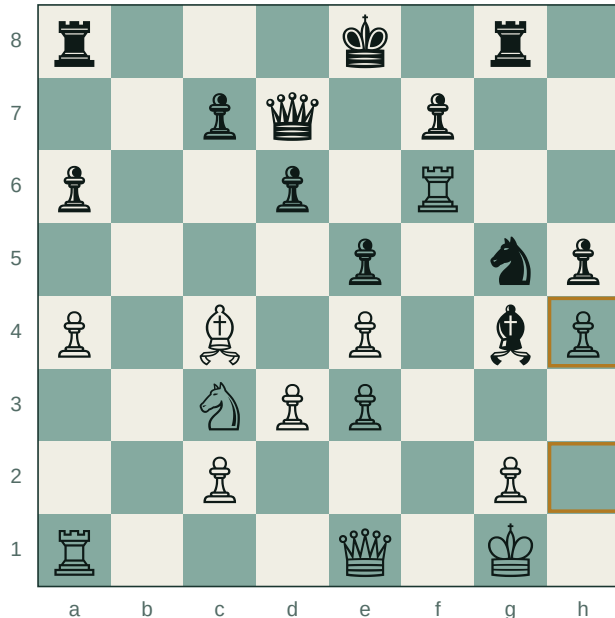


# Kingside attacks: Black, move 19

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 19.h4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**19...Nf3+ 20. Kf1 Nxe1**

**19...Nf3+** Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From f3 it attacks king on g1 and queen on e1. Recorded reply: **20.Kf1**.

**20...Nxe1** The knight captures the queen on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -1 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on f6. Check for tactical protection.